

SAMPLE DATA · invented figures for demonstration

Which jobs actually make money?

Period: March 2026. Every job's gross margin: revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time at \$68 an hour (fully loaded: wages and all on-costs). Before overheads, so this is not profit. Pick a type of job and every number, chart and note on the page follows it.

How final is this data?

- February 2026

Locked

February 2026 is locked (closed 3 Mar 2026). These numbers won't change.
- March 2026

Locked

March 2026 is locked (closed 2 Apr 2026). These numbers won't change.
- October 2026

Incomplete

October 2026 is still in progress: figures to 6 Oct only.

Gross margin, not profit

Gross margin is not profit. Job gross margin = revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time charged to the job at \$68 an hour (wages and all on-costs). Not included: technician time not charged to any job (travel, training, waiting), and overheads (office wages, marketing, vehicles, rent, insurance, IT, depreciation, interest). Profit is what's left after those. Wages always include all on-costs: super, payroll tax, workers' compensation insurance and leave.

From gross margin to profit

March's jobs made \$68,158 gross margin (35.6%). Technician time not charged to jobs took (\$1,092) and overheads \$59,200, leaving \$10,050 profit before tax (5.2% of revenue). To cover overheads, jobs need a 30.3% gross margin on average.

Gross margin on jobs	\$68,158
Technician wages and on-costs	\$54,600
Technician time charged to jobs (at cost)	\$55,692
Technician time not charged to jobs	(\$1,092)
Gross profit (the P&L)	\$69,250
Overheads (operating expenses, depreciation, interest)	\$59,200
Profit before tax (the P&L)	\$10,050
Revenue	\$191,500
Gross margin on jobs, %	35.6%
Profit before tax, % of revenue	5.2%
Gross margin jobs need just to cover overheads and time not charged	30.3%

Type of job: All jobs

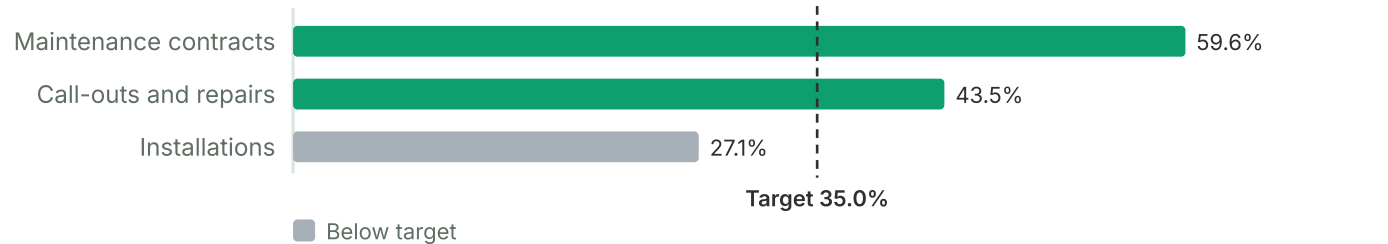
Job gross margin, March · All jobs

35.6%

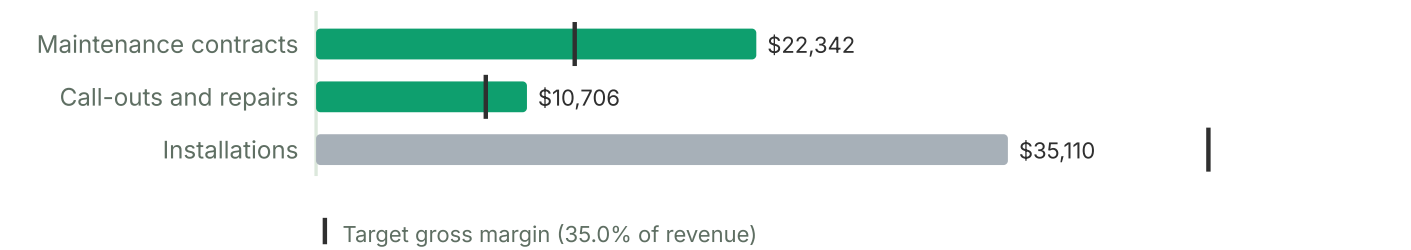
February 38.6%

Job gross margin by type of job, March 2026

Gross margin %



Gross margin \$



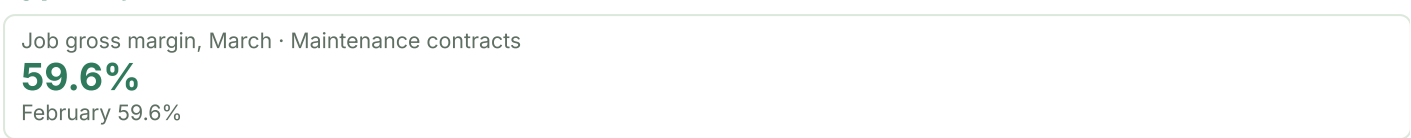
What it shows

In March maintenance contracts made a 59.6% job gross margin, installations made a 27.1% job gross margin, call-outs and repairs made a 43.5% job gross margin (technician time at \$68 an hour, wages and all on-costs). Jobs need 30.3% just to cover overheads.

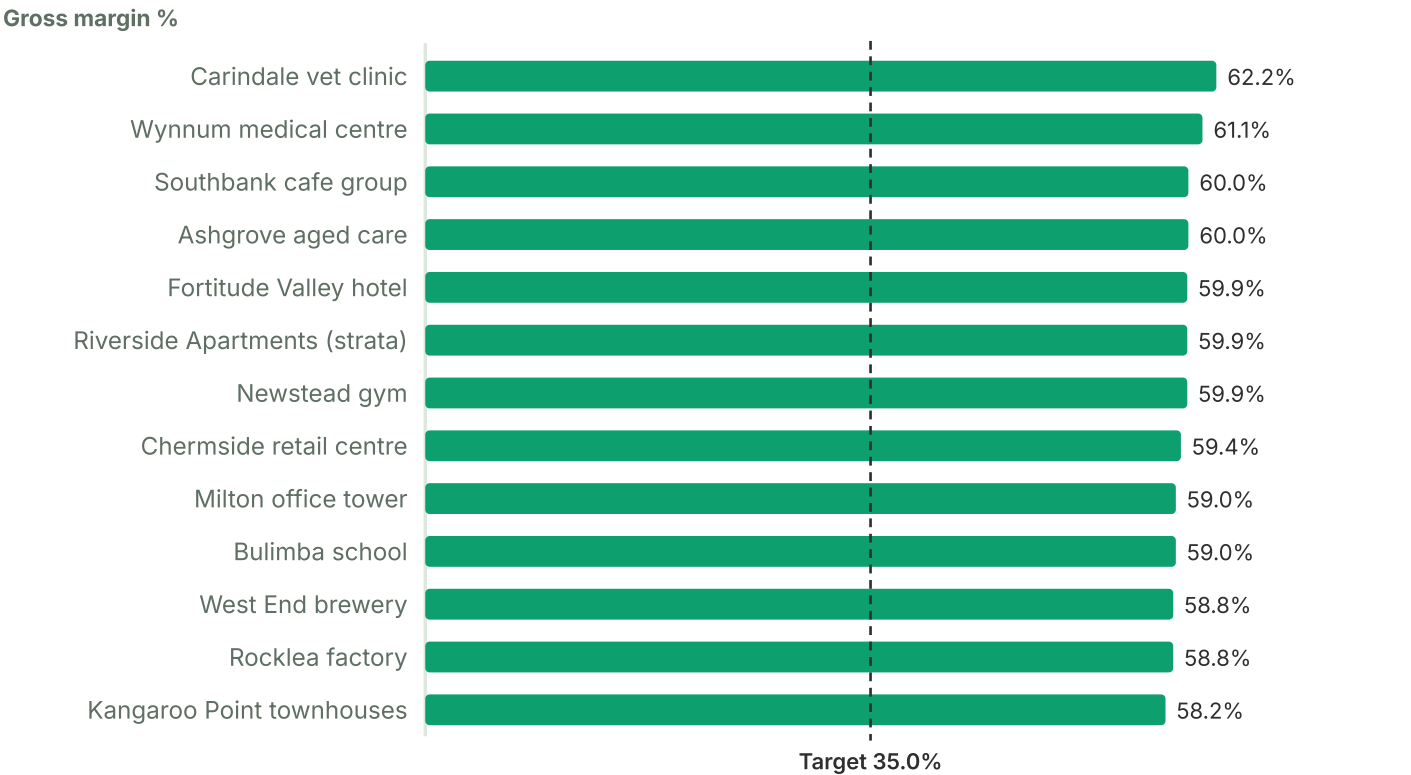
What you'd do about it

Maintenance contracts: 59.6% gross margin, the most profitable work you do. Installations: 27.1% gross margin, below the 30.3% needed to cover overheads.

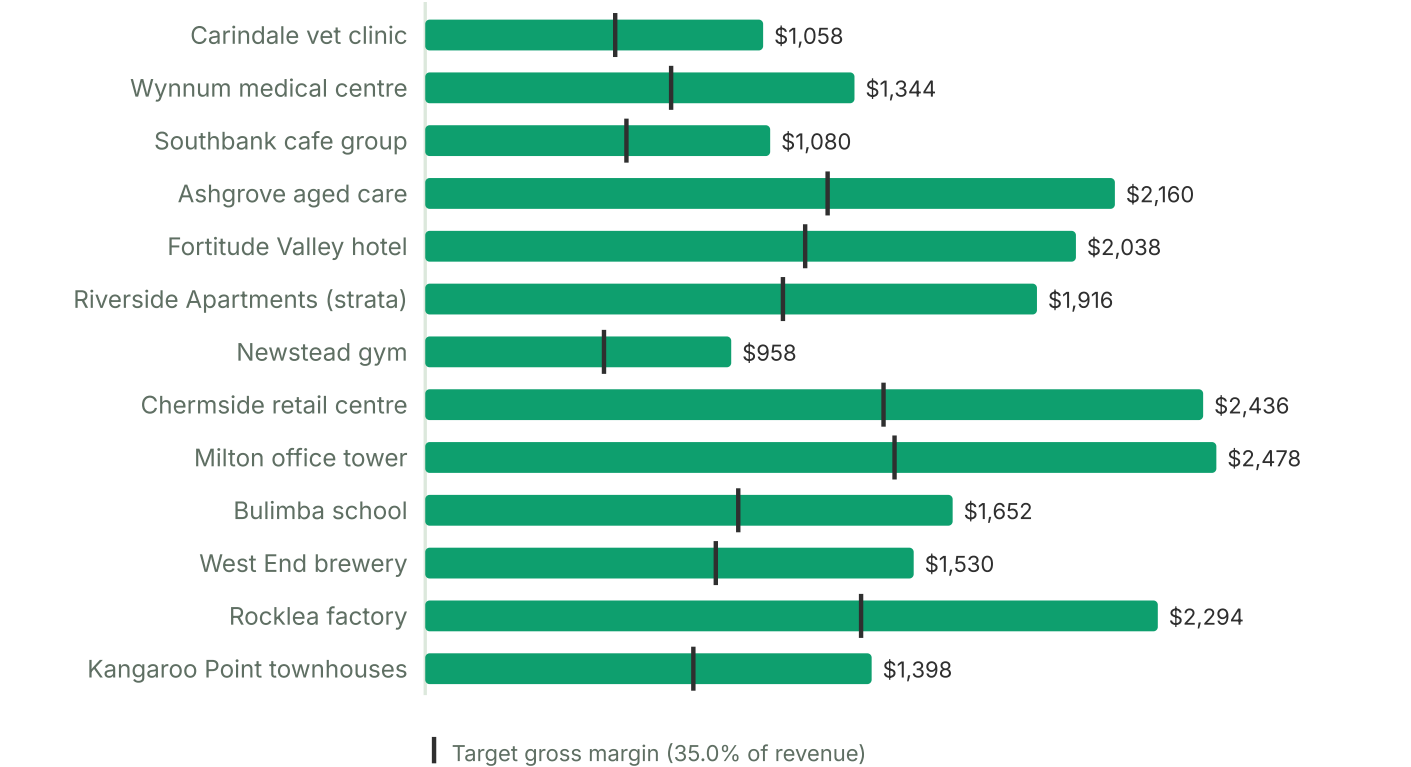
Type of job: Maintenance contracts



Job gross margin on each maintenance contract, March 2026



Gross margin \$



What it shows

All 13 contracts made more than the 35.0% job gross margin target. The thinnest was Kangaroo Point townhouses at 58.2% job gross margin: 14.0 h of technician time on a \$2,400 monthly fee.

What you'd do about it

The Kangaroo Point townhouses contract: 58.2% gross margin, 27.9 points clear of the 30.3% overheads need. Maintenance contracts overall: 59.6% gross margin.

Type of job: Installations

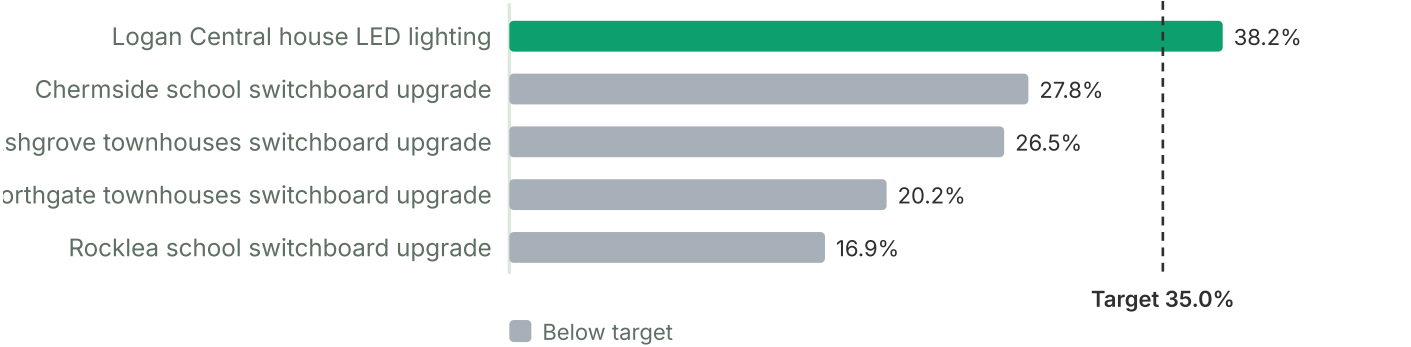
Job gross margin, March · Installations

27.1%

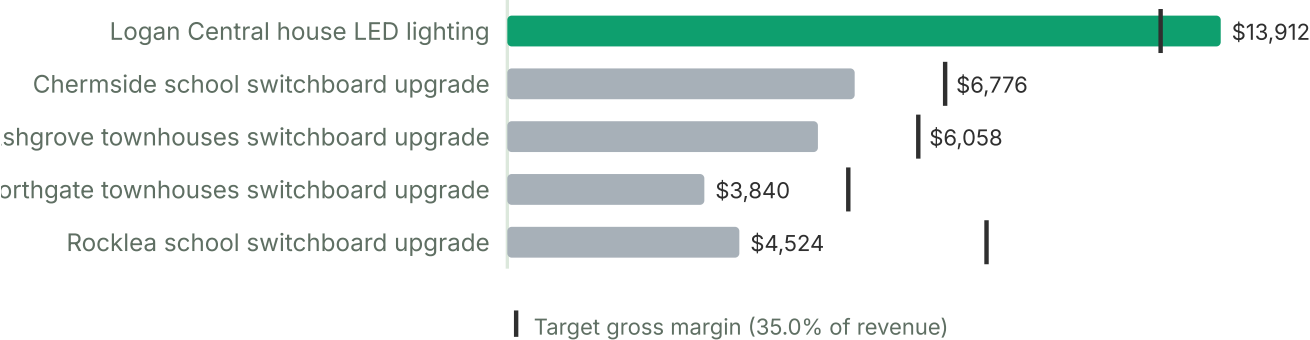
February 31.2%

Job gross margin on each installation invoiced in March 2026

Gross margin %



Gross margin \$



What it shows

4 of the 5 installation jobs invoiced in March made less than the 35.0% job gross margin target. The Rocklea school switchboard upgrade made a 16.9% job gross margin: 107.0 h of technician time (\$7,276) and \$2,700 of subcontractors on a \$26,700 job. Jobs need 30.3% gross margin just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

Below the 30.3% overheads need: Chermside school switchboard upgrade (27.8%), Ashgrove townhouses switchboard upgrade (26.5%), Northgate townhouses switchboard upgrade (20.2%), Rocklea school switchboard upgrade (16.9%). Most profitable: Logan Central house LED lighting (38.2%).

Type of job: Call-outs and repairs

Job gross margin, March · Call-outs and repairs

43.5%

February 43.8%

Technician time charged, March

\$16,748

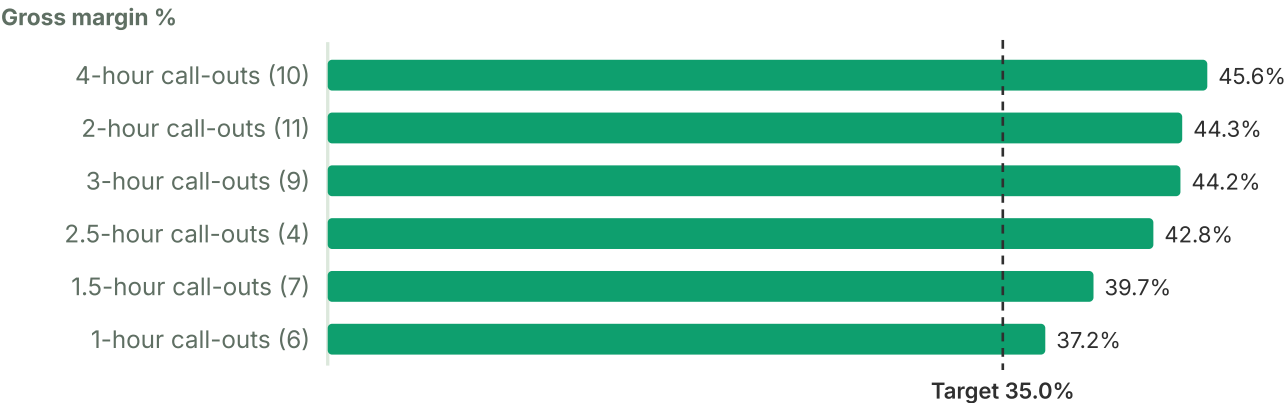
68.1% of call-out revenue

Materials charged, March

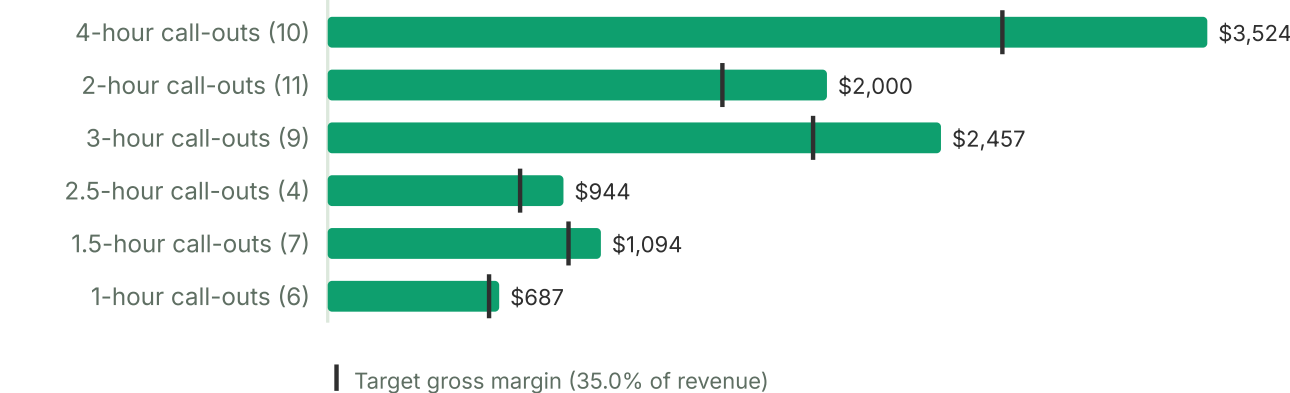
\$7,852

\$6,040 at cost, plus 30%

Job gross margin on call-outs by length, March 2026



Gross margin \$



What it shows

47 call-outs in March billed \$16,748 of technician time and \$7,852 of materials (\$6,040 at cost plus 30%), and made a 43.5% job gross margin between them. Gross margins run from 37.2% to 45.6% by length: the hourly rate covers technician time comfortably, so the gross margin mostly moves with how much material goes on the van.

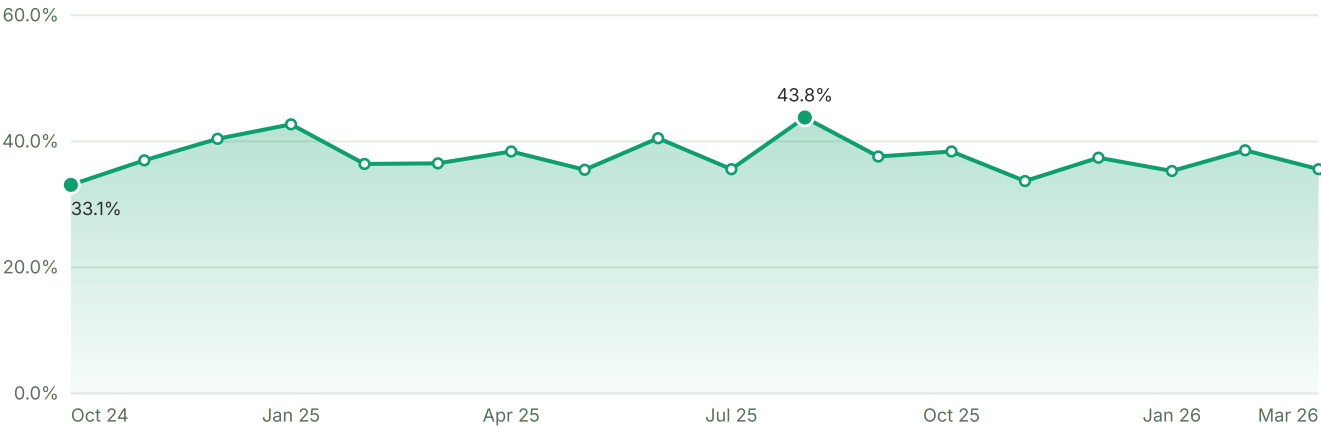
What you'd do about it

Call-outs: 43.5% gross margin, 13.2 points clear of the 30.3% overheads need.

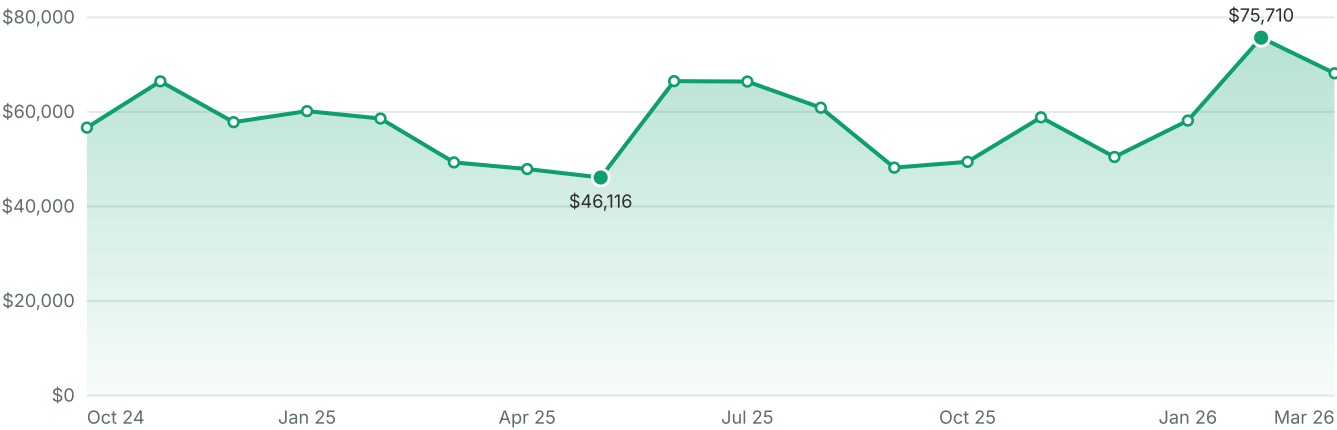
Every type of job at once

Job gross margin by month

All · Gross margin %



All · Gross margin \$



Tap a month for its workings. Every month, by line, is in the Excel download.